

LIVRET D'EXCELLENCE TOUT-EN-UN

UNIT 4: LIFE ISSUES

Chapter 31: A Newscast (Page 222)

Ce livret d'excellence tout-en-un a été conçu pour offrir une préparation académique de niveau prestige pour l'épreuve nationale d'Anglais au Baccalauréat. Il intègre une analyse thématique exhaustive de la leçon **A Newscast**, le portefeuille lexical requis, les structures de la grammaire passive et passive-déductive, le module phonologique d'examen, un recueil de 40 flashcards en révision active, et un quiz d'auto-évaluation corrigé pas-à-pas.

Sujets Fondamentaux Couverts :

- Theme: Environmental Disasters (California Cold Snap, Typhoons) & Student Housing Reports
- Grammar: The Passive Voice & Reporting Passive Structures (e.g., 'It is expected that...')
- Phonetics: Alliteration, Metaphors, Word Stress & Silent Letters
- Skills: Measurement Conversions (Celsius/Fahrenheit, feet, yards, miles, pounds, stones)
- Writing: Narrative News Reports using Passive structures

PART 1: THE EXHAUSTIVE COURSE THEORY

1. Reading Analysis & Contextual Synthesis

The lesson **A Newscast** focuses on how news is written, structured, and reported globally. The official textbook exposes three major text blocks: first, the **California Winter Cold Snap**; second, the **Student Accommodation Crisis**; and third, the **Art Display** announcement. By analyzing these texts, students learn to extract essential news data, interpret journalistic metaphors, and understand passive constructions which are standard in formal reporting.

Text A: California Extreme Cold Snap (AFP Report): A state of emergency was declared in California as temperatures plummeted near record lows due to an arctic low-pressure system from Alaska. This 'cold snap' threatened vulnerable populations (the old, frail, and homeless) and forced widespread school closures due to ice and snow in the mountainous San Diego region. Journalists utilize vivid imagery and metaphors such as 'Snowstorm blankets London in wintry white' to create powerful mental impressions.

Text B: Student Accommodation Crisis: Accommodation costs have risen for the **fourth consecutive year**, forcing students to pay an average of **£80 a week**. This financial burden challenges students' ability to make ends meet, raising a major social debate on higher education affordability.

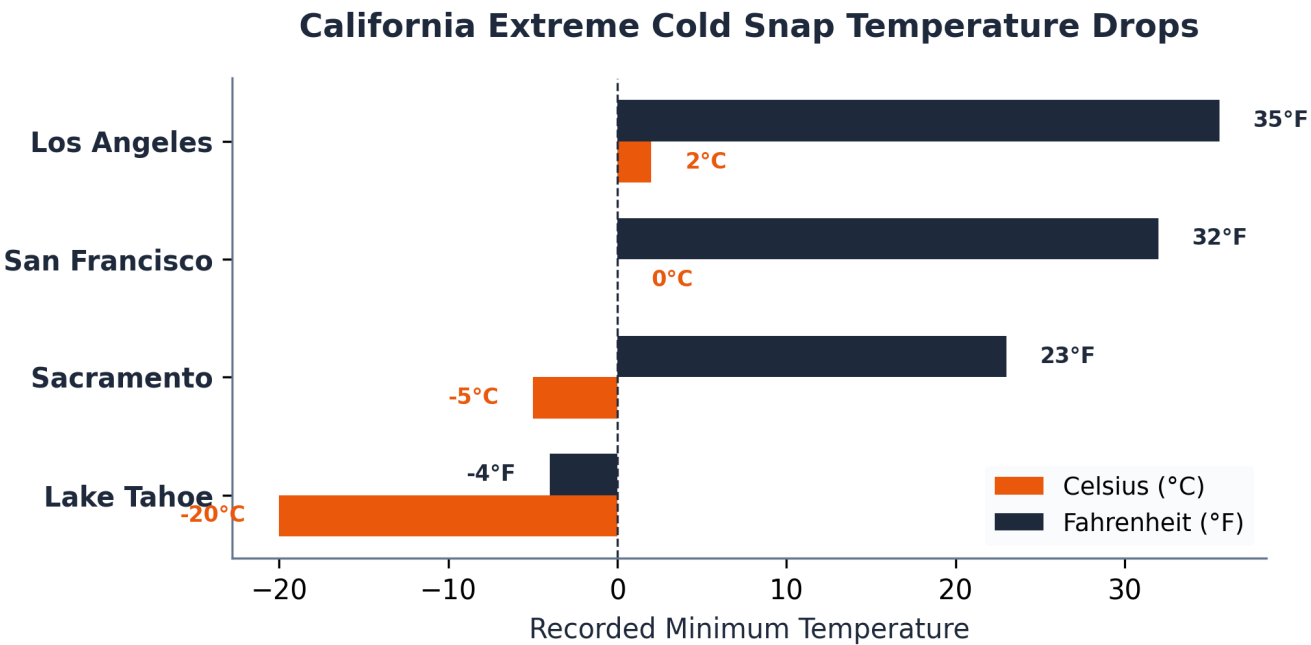


Figure 1.1: California Cold Snap Temperatures across Key Regions (C vs F)

2. Thematic Vocabulary Portfolio

Lexical Item & IPA	Part of Speech	Definition & Synonym	French Translation & BAC Context
plummet /'plʌm.ɪt/	Verb	To fall or drop straight down at high speed. Syn: plunge, nose-dive	Chuter, s'effondrer. Ex: Temperatures plummeted to record lows.
casualty /'kæʒ.u.əl.ti/	Noun	A person killed or injured in a war or accident. Syn: victim	Victime, blessé. Ex: The typhoon caused several casualties.
crippled /'krɪp.əld/	Adj / Verb	Severely damaged, ruined, or disabled. Syn: paralyzed, devastated	Paralysé, dévasté. Ex: Transport networks were crippled by ice.
unseasonally /ʌn'siː.zən.əl.i/	Adverb	Not typical or normal for the time of year. Syn: unusually	Hors saison. Ex: Widespread cold snap in sunny California.
hamper /'hæm.pər/	Verb	To hinder, obstruct, or impede movement. Syn: block, delay	Entraver, gêner. Ex: Rescue operations were hampered by winds.
make ends meet /meɪk endz mi:t/	Idiom	To earn just enough money to pay for basic life expenses.	Joindre les deux bouts. Ex: Students struggle due to high rents (£80/week).
consecutive /kən'sek.jə.tɪv/	Adj	Following continuously; in unbroken sequence. Syn: successive	Consécutif. Ex: Accommodation costs rose for the fourth consecutive year.
dumped /dʌmpt/	Verb (past)	Deposited or dropped in a large, sudden quantity.	Déversé, déchargé. Ex: The arctic low system dumped ice on mountains.

3. Grammar Mastery: The Passive Voice in Journalistic Reporting

In journalistic texts (like newscasts), the ****Passive Voice**** is highly preferred. It is used when:

1. The **doer of the action is unknown** (e.g., 'The window was broken').
2. The **action itself is far more important** than who did it (e.g., 'A state of emergency was declared').
3. We want to maintain an **impersonal, objective, and formal tone**.

Passive Voice Tense Chart (Formula: BE + Past Participle V3)

Tense	Active Structure	Passive Structure	Exam Application Example
Present Simple	Subject + V / V-s	Subject + am/is/are + V3	Officials declare an emergency. → An emergency is declared .
Past Simple	Subject + V-ed (V2)	Subject + was/were + V3	The storm forced school closures. → School closures were forced .
Present Perfect	Subject + has/have + V3	Subject + has/have been + V3	They have cancelled the flight. → The flight has been cancelled .
Past Perfect	Subject + had + V3	Subject + had been + V3	The wind had destroyed houses. → Houses had been destroyed .
Future Simple	Subject + will + verb	Subject + will be + V3	They will display the paintings. → The paintings will be displayed .
Modals	Subject + Modal + verb	Subject + Modal + be + V3	The cold could close schools. → Schools could be closed by the cold.

Prestige BAC Structures: Impersonal Passive Reporting

When reporting opinions or rumors formally, we use the following structures:

- **Structure A:** It + is + believed/thought/reported + that + Clause
→ 'It is thought that for some people it won't make a difference.'
- **Structure B:** Subject + am/is/are + expected/believed/said + to + Infinitive
→ 'Temperatures are expected to drop to 2 degrees Celsius.'

4. Phonetics, Imagery & Literary Devices Module

Alliteration (Allitération): The repetition of initial consonant sounds in consecutive words to create emphasis and rhythm. In the headline '**S**nowstorm blankets London in wintry **w**hite', we see alliteration with the sound /s/ and /w/.

Metaphor & Imagery (Métaphore et Imagerie): Descriptive language that represents objects or actions symbolically. Describing snow as a 'blanket' is a metaphor representing a thick, insulating protective layer over the city.

5. Writing Methodology: The Journalistic News Report

A news report follows a specific layout: a striking headline, a lead sentence containing the Who, What, Where, When, followed by passive descriptions of the event and causatives (cause and effect). Below is an d'excellence model paragraph that students can memorize for writing tasks.

Model News Report Paragraph (12 Lines):

A severe typhoon has swept across Southeast Asia, causing extensive damage and leaving thousands homeless. A state of emergency was declared yesterday after the storm, named Typhoon Nari, dumped over ten inches of rain within twelve hours. Because of the torrential rains, major transport networks have been utterly crippled, and local flights were immediately cancelled. Rescue operations are currently being hampered by unseasonably strong winds and mudslides. Furthermore, electricity lines have been knocked down, leaving cities in total darkness. Although the local government has deployed emergency relief funds, the number of casualties is expected to rise. Unless immediate measures are taken by global bodies, the socio-economic impact on these deprived regions will be disastrously worsened.

PART 2: THE ACTIVE RECALL REPOSITORY

Ce recueil contient exactement 40 questions-réponses clés de révision active. Pliez la page ou masquez la colonne de droite pour vous évaluer activement.

Question (Active Recall)	Model Answer (Grounding & Corrections)
Q1: What caused the state of emergency to be declared in California?	It was declared because of 'extreme low temperatures' (an arctic low-pressure system from Alaska) that threatened lives.
Q2: Who was threatened by the California cold snap?	The cold snap threatened the most vulnerable groups: the old, the frail, and the homeless.
Q3: What forced the closure of schools in San Diego?	Widespread school closures were forced by a heavy dump of snow and ice on mountainous areas.
Q4: Identify a metaphor used in the newscast to describe cold weather.	Snow and unseasonal winter weather are described as 'a blanket of cold weather' or 'snowstorm blankets London'.
Q5: What is the meaning of the idiom 'to make ends meet'?	It means to earn or have just enough money to pay for basic survival necessities (rent, food, utility bills).
Q6: By how many consecutive years have student housing rents increased?	Student accommodation costs have risen for the fourth consecutive year .
Q7: What is the average weekly rent paid by students in the report?	Students pay an average of £80 a week for accommodation.
Q8: Which city in California was expected to drop to -5°C?	Sacramento, the state capital of California, was expected to drop to minus five degrees Celsius overnight.
Q9: What was the overnight temperature expected in San Francisco?	San Francisco was expected to shiver at exactly 0 degrees Celsius .
Q10: What temperature was recorded at Lake Tahoe?	Lake Tahoe was expected to plunge to minus 20 degrees Celsius (-20°C) .
Q11: What does the term 'cold snap' stand for?	A sudden, brief, and intense period of extremely cold weather.
Q12: In the weather forecast, how will the morning begin?	Tomorrow will begin rather misty and with mist over the hills .
Q13: Why are drivers asked to keep their headlights on?	Because visibility will still be limited as the mist over the hills will not have fully cleared by mid-morning.
Q14: Paraphrase the verb 'plummet' using a synonym.	To plummet means to plunge, collapse, drop sharply, or fall steeply at high velocity.

Question (Active Recall)	Model Answer (Grounding & Corrections)
Q15: What kind of paintings are currently on display in the city museum?	Impressionist paintings are on display in the city museum.
Q16: Active: 'An arctic system from Alaska caused the cold snap.' Convert to Passive.	The cold snap was caused by an arctic low-pressure system from Alaska.
Q17: Active: 'The authorities declared a state of emergency.' Convert to Passive.	A state of emergency was declared by the authorities.
Q18: Active: 'Rents have forced students to live in poverty.' Convert to Passive.	Students have been forced by rents to live in poverty.
Q19: Active: 'The school board closed twenty schools yesterday.' Convert to Passive.	Twenty schools were closed yesterday by the school board.
Q20: Active: 'The storm will delay rescue operations.' Convert to Passive.	Rescue operations will be delayed by the storm.
Q21: Active: 'Fahrenheit proposed this temperature scale in 1724.' Convert to Passive.	This temperature scale was proposed by Daniel Gabriel Fahrenheit in 1724.
Q22: Active: 'People expect temperatures to drop tonight.' Convert using 'It is...'	It is expected that temperatures will drop tonight.
Q23: Active: 'They say that the typhoon is approaching.' Convert to personal passive.	The typhoon is said to be approaching.
Q24: Why is 'The emergency was declared...' better than 'Officials declared the emergency' in news?	Because the action (declaring emergency) is more important than who did it, maintaining formal objectivity.
Q25: Rewrite: 'We must help the homeless' using passive modal.	The homeless must be helped.
Q26: Rewrite: 'The arctic low dumped an inch of snow' in passive.	An inch of snow was dumped by the arctic low-pressure system.

Question (Active Recall)	Model Answer (Grounding & Corrections)
Q27: Rewrite: 'The museum is displaying Impressionist art.' in passive.	Impressionist art is being displayed in the museum.
Q28: Active: 'Writers utilize metaphors to impress the readers.' Convert to Passive.	Metaphors are utilized by writers to impress the readers.
Q29: Rewrite: 'They had cancelled the flight before the typhoon hit.' in passive.	The flight had been cancelled before the typhoon hit.
Q30: Turn to active: 'Visibility is limited by the dense mist.'	The dense mist limits visibility.
Q31: Identify alliteration in: 'Snowstorm blankets London in wintry white.'	The repetition of the initial consonant sounds: /s/ in Snowstorm and /w/ in wintry white.
Q32: What is the silent letter in the word 'environment'?	The letter ' n ' is silent (or heavily muted) in /ɪn'vaɪ.rən.mənt/.
Q33: Identify the silent letters in 'exhaust' and 'alignment'.	In 'exhaust', ' h ' is silent (/ɪg'zɔːst/). In 'alignment', ' g ' is silent (/ə'lɑɪn.mənt/).
Q34: Where does the stress lie in the word 'consecutive'?	The stress is on the second syllable: con- SEC -u-tive (/kən'sek.jə.tɪv/).
Q35: Where does the stress lie in 'unseasonally'?	The primary stress lies on the second syllable of the root: un- SEA -son-al-ly.
Q36: Explain the difference between 'It's raining cats and dogs' and 'It never rains but it pours'.	'Raining cats and dogs' means heavy rain. 'It never rains but it pours' is an idiom meaning problems always arrive all at once.
Q37: What is the formula to convert Celsius to Fahrenheit?	$^{\circ}\text{F} = (^{\circ}\text{C} \times 1.8) + 32$.
Q38: Convert 0°C to Fahrenheit using the formula.	$^{\circ}\text{F} = (0 \times 1.8) + 32 = \mathbf{32^{\circ}\text{F}}$ (Freezing point of water).
Q39: What does 1 foot (ft) stand for in meters?	1 foot is equal to exactly 0.3048 meters (or 30.48 cm).
Q40: How many kilograms are there in 1 pound (lb)?	1 pound is equal to exactly 0.453592 kilograms .

PART 3: EXAM EVALUATION QUIZ & SUMMARY MEMOS

1. Diagnostic Exam Quiz (10 Questions)

Ce quiz évalue de façon rigoureuse votre maîtrise des points de grammaire, de lexique et de phonétique du Chapitre 31. Répondez aux questions avant de lire la correction.

No.	Question Prompt	Type	Focus Area
1	Which of the following is the passive form of: 'The cold snap has crippled transport networks.'?	MCQ	Grammar (Passive)
2	What is the equivalent of 4,000 feet in meters?	MCQ	Measurement conversion
3	Identify the word containing a silent letter: 'threatened', 'plummet', 'exhaust', 'unseasonally'.	MCQ	Phonetics (Silent letters)
4	Complete: 'Accommodation costs have risen for the fourth _____ year.'	MCQ	Lexis (Listening)
5	What does 'could' express in: 'The snow level could drop to 1,500 feet.'?	MCQ	Modal semantics
6	True or False: The word 'Fahrenheit' has a silent letter 'h'.	V/F	Silent Letters
7	True or False: Rents for students have reached an average of £18 a week.	V/F	Course Statistics
8	True or False: The passive structure 'It is said that...' can be rewritten as 'Subject + is said + to + verb'.	V/F	Grammar Syntax
9	True or False: Alliteration is the repetition of vowel sounds inside words.	V/F	Literary Devices
10	True or False: -40°C is equal to -40°F.	V/F	Physics / Conversions

Detailed Correction & Explanations

1. **Correct Answer:** 'Transport networks have been crippled by the cold snap.' (Present Perfect Passive: has/have been + V3).
2. **Correct Answer: 1,219.2 meters** ($4,000 \times 0.3048 \text{ m} = 1,219.2 \text{ m}$).
3. **Correct Answer: 'exhaust'** (the letter 'h' is silent: /ɪg'zɔːst/).
4. **Correct Answer: 'consecutive'** (from Text B: 'fourth consecutive year').
5. **Correct Answer: Possibility in the future** (could expresses low-to-medium probability).
6. **True:** The 'h' after the first 'r' in 'Fahrenheit' (/ˈfær.ən.haɪt/) is completely silent.
7. **False:** Student rents rose to an average of **£80 a week** (the £18 option was a distractor).
8. **True:** Both reporting structures are grammatically equivalent and highly valued in BAC essays.
9. **False:** Alliteration is the repetition of consonant sounds. The repetition of vowel sounds is called assonance.
10. **True:** -40 is the unique intersection point where both Celsius and Fahrenheit scales are equal.

2. Summary Memos (Mémors d'Excellence)

Tableau Mémo 1.1: Active & Passive Voice Reporting Matrix

Reporting Verb Active	Impersonal Passive (It is...)	Personal Passive (S + is...)	BAC Application Rule
People believe	It is believed that...	Subject is believed to...	No double negative allowed
Journalists report	It is reported that...	Subject is reported to...	Must respect time concordance
We expect	It is expected that...	Subject is expected to...	Followed by infinitive 'to'
They say	It is said that...	Subject is said to...	Highly valued in essays

Tableau M  mo 1.2: Measurement Conversion Cheat Sheet

Category	Metric Unit	Imperial / Other Unit	Exact Formula / Value	BAC Application Example
Temperature	Celsius (�C)	Fahrenheit (�F)	$�F = (�C \times 1.8) + 32$	$0�C = 32�F / 100�C = 212�F$
Length	Meter (m)	Foot (ft / ')	$1 \text{ ft} = 0.3048 \text{ m}$	$4,000 \text{ ft} = 1,219.2 \text{ m}$
Length	Meter (m)	Yard (yd)	$1 \text{ yd} = 0.9144 \text{ m}$	$6 \text{ yards} = 5.486 \text{ m}$
Distance	Kilometer (km)	Mile (mi)	$1 \text{ mi} = 1.60934 \text{ km}$	$2 \text{ miles} = 3.218 \text{ km}$
Weight	Kilogram (kg)	Pound (lb)	$1 \text{ lb} = 0.453592 \text{ kg}$	$150 \text{ lbs} = 68.03 \text{ kg}$
Weight	Kilogram (kg)	Stone (st)	$1 \text{ st} = 6.35029 \text{ kg}$	$10 \text{ stones} = 63.5 \text{ kg}$
Weight	Gram (g)	Ounce (oz)	$1 \text{ oz} = 28.3495 \text{ g}$	$10 \text{ oz} = 283.49 \text{ g}$